

Batman's Treaty: sentences to cut out

Sheet 1 of 2. Cut along the dashed lines. Keep the numbers, they are how a mistake gets found later.

1 the two documents disagree because they were written for different purposes, one to justify a land claim, one to control it

2 useful for showing what people wore and carried

3 Burt's 1875 painting, made forty years later for people who had not seen it happen

4 it cannot tell us what the Kulin people actually thought

5 In the 1830s, Britain claimed Australia belonged to no one, so land could not legally be bought from its people

6 painting of Batman's meeting with the Kulin Nation

7 The meeting sits inside a bigger argument: colonists wanted land, while British law increasingly held that Aboriginal people could not sell land they were said not to own

8 Batman's own deed, the paper in his hand in the painting, says the Kulin people agreed to sell

9 it cannot be trusted as a record of what was said or agreed, because the artist was not there

10 the day Batman said he bought Kulin land

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11 a later artwork by John Wesley Burt, made about forty years afterwards to record the meeting

12 The Proclamation disagrees

13 it was painted forty years later, by someone who was not there

14 Batman claimed the Kulin people agreed to sell their land

15 Batman wanted land, and colonists were arguing about whether buying land from Aboriginal people was even allowed

16 Burt's 1875 artwork of Batman's 1835 meeting with the Kulin Nation

17 remember an event some colonists were proud of

18 weak evidence of what actually happened, since no Kulin account of the day survives

19 blankets with gifts on them

20 the painting takes neither side, it simply shows the meeting happening